

IN THE SENATE

SENATE JOINT MEMORIAL NO. 110

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A JOINT MEMORIAL

TO THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES, THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE UNITED STATES IN CONGRESS ASSEMBLED, THE CONGRESSIONAL DELEGATION REPRESENTING THE STATE OF IDAHO IN THE CONGRESS OF THE UNITED STATES, THE UNITED STATES TRADE REPRESENTATIVE AMBASSADOR, THE SECRETARY OF THE UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE, AND THE SECRETARY OF THE UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE.

We, your Memorialists, the Senate and the House of Representatives of the State of Idaho assembled in the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, do hereby respectfully represent that:

WHEREAS, Idaho is the second-largest producer of sugar beets in the United States, with approximately 170,000 acres of sugar beet farmland under production, generating more than \$1 billion annually and supporting over 500 farm families; and

WHEREAS, sugar beets are the heartbeat of Idaho's rural communities, sustaining farm families, processors, and local economies that depend on a strong agricultural base; and

WHEREAS, Idaho's sugar processing industry employs approximately 2,000 people, providing well-paying jobs in rural Idaho; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. sugar market is experiencing a historic oversupply, largely driven by foreign imports that are benefiting from government subsidies and the dumping of sugar at prices below the cost of production, thereby eroding domestic sugar beet prices and forcing farmers to harvest at a loss; and

WHEREAS, sugar beet market prices have declined by more than 42% over the past two years, placing severe financial strain on domestic producers; and

WHEREAS, since the 2018 Farm Bill's enactment, on-farm production costs have increased by more than 30%, while interest costs have surged by 73% since 2020, thereby dramatically increasing the cost of operating a farm; and

WHEREAS, since 2000, the U.S. sugar beet industry has been forced to close eleven sugar beet processing factories, resulting in lost processing capacity, lost jobs, and long-term economic harm to rural communities; and

WHEREAS, President Trump's America First agenda prioritizes protecting American farmers and workers, confronting unfair foreign trade practices, and strengthening domestic supply chains critical to the nation's economy; and

WHEREAS, the tier-2 over-quota duty on imported sugar is intended to function as a prohibitive safeguard against excessive foreign imports, ensuring fair trade practices and protecting domestic sugar beet growers and workers from unfairly traded sugar; and

1 WHEREAS, the tier-2 duty has not been adjusted since 2000, reducing its
2 effectiveness in preventing foreign sugar from entering the U.S. market at
3 prices that undermine domestic production.

4 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Ses-
5 sion of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the Senate and the House of Rep-
6 resentatives concurring therein, that the Legislature urges immediate ac-
7 tion to raise the tier-2 duty on imported sugar to restore its intended pro-
8 tective function and to prioritize American farmers, workers, and rural com-
9 munities.

10 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature respectfully calls on Con-
11 gress and the Trump Administration to put American interests first by pre-
12 venting policies that enrich foreign governments at the expense of American
13 farmers and workers and to take decisive action to address the devastating
14 effects of oversupply caused by unfairly traded imports.

15 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Secretary of the Senate be, and she is
16 hereby authorized and directed to forward a copy of this Memorial to the
17 President of the United States, the President of the Senate and the Speaker
18 of the House of Representatives of Congress, the congressional delegation
19 representing the State of Idaho in the Congress of the United States, the
20 United States Trade Representative Ambassador, the Secretary of the United
21 States Department of Commerce, and the Secretary of the United States De-
22 partment of Agriculture.